

Professional English

Course Writing Assignments

Weeks 2 and 4

Assignment 1 – **Deadline:** Week 2, Sunday, 23:59

Write a short essay of 300–350 words on the following topic: **Which competences are most important for achieving the Sustainable Development Goals?**

In your essay:

- identify 2–3 competences that you consider most important for achieving the SDGs;
- explain why you consider these competences particularly important;
- support your arguments with ideas or findings from Beagon et al. (2022);
- provide relevant examples or explanations to develop your arguments;
- organise your essay into an introduction, body paragraphs, and conclusion;
- use appropriate academic and professional vocabulary, linking devices, and cautious/hedging language where appropriate;
- write 300–350 words.

Reading resource: Beagon, U., Kövesi, K., Tabas, B., Nørgaard, B., Lehtinen, R., Bowe, B., Gillet, C., & Spliid, C. M. (2022). Preparing engineering students for the challenges of the SDGs: what competences are required? *European Journal of Engineering Education*, 48(1), 1–23. <https://doi.org/10.1080/03043797.2022.2033955>

Assignment 2 – **Deadline:** Week 4, Sunday, 23:59

Write an academic opinion essay of 300–350 words on the following topic: **Will AI have a more positive or negative impact on society and the economy?**

In your essay:

- clearly state whether you believe the overall impact of AI will be more positive or more negative;
- discuss the impact of AI on either society or the economy;
- develop your position with relevant arguments, explanations, and examples;
- consider possible benefits, risks, or unintended consequences of AI;
- organise your essay into an introduction, body paragraphs, and conclusion;
- use appropriate academic vocabulary, linking devices, and hedging language;
- write 300–350 words.

Reading resource: Campbell, W. (2023). *Living with AI*. Monash University Publishing.

<https://research.ebsco.com/linkprocessor/plink?id=358daa29-9d9b-38b1-901b-19ea7a619f67>

Assignment 3 – **Deadline:** Week 6, Sunday, 23:59

Write a short essay of 300–350 words on the following topic: **How can science education help people evaluate misinformation in science or technology?**

In your essay:

- explain how the misinformation spread and why it may have appeared credible;
- explain how competencies could help people distinguish reliable scientific information from misleading claims;
- suggest practical strategies for preventing similar misinformation, drawing on the article's discussion of science media literacy;
- support your analysis with relevant ideas, findings, or examples from Allchin (2023);
- organise your essay into an introduction, body paragraphs, and conclusion;
- use appropriate academic vocabulary, linking devices, and cautious/hedging language where appropriate;
- write 300–350 words.

Reading resource: Allchin, D. (2023). Ten competencies for the science misinformation crisis. *Science Education*, 107, 261–274. <https://doi.org/10.1002/sce.21746>

Assignment 4 – **Deadline:** Week 8, Sunday, 23:59

Write a 300–350-word analytical essay on the following topic: **What makes negotiation successful, and how can effective preparation influence the outcome of a negotiation?**

In your essay:

- explain why negotiation is important for resolving conflicts and making decisions;
- discuss the importance of communication, decision-making, and evaluating new information during negotiation;
- provide a relevant example from business, education, international relations, or everyday life;
- support your analysis with relevant ideas from Parvaneh and Akbari (2022);
- organise your essay into an introduction, body paragraphs, and conclusion;
- use appropriate academic and professional vocabulary, linking devices, and cautious language;
- write 300–350 words.

Reading resource

Parvaneh, A., & Akbari, V. (2022). Negotiation Processes: Tactics of Preparing a Successful Negotiation. *International Journal of Innovation in Marketing Elements*, 2(1), 51–58. <https://doi.org/10.59615/ijime.2.1.51>

You are strongly recommended to write the essay **without using generative AI**. The purpose of the assignment is to develop your own academic writing skills and prepare

you for the writing component of the examination. Submitted work will be checked using StrikePlagiarism AI detection. The maximum permitted level of AI-detected content is 15%.

Assessment Criteria

Criterion	Description	Points
Task achievement	Fully addresses the essay question; identifies relevant competences; presents a clear position and provides convincing justification.	25
Use of the source and development of ideas	Uses relevant ideas/findings from research articles; develops arguments through explanation and relevant examples.	20
Organisation and coherence	Organises the essay effectively with a clear introduction, logically developed body paragraphs, and conclusion; uses cohesive devices appropriately.	20
Vocabulary and academic style	Uses a good range of appropriate academic and topic-specific vocabulary; maintains an appropriate academic register and uses hedging where relevant.	20
Grammar and language accuracy	Uses a range of grammatical structures accurately; errors are limited and do not interfere with communication. Meets the required length of 300–350 words.	15
Total		100